

Word family: **power / powers / powerful / powerfully / powerless / powerlessness / empower / empowered / empowerment**

Base word: power

Plural: powers

Related forms: powerful, powerfully, powerless, powerlessness, empower, empowered, empowerment

Useful expressions / extensions: have the power to, in power, come to power, power supply, power failure, purchasing power, computing power, power of attorney

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / verb in technical uses (技術性動詞) / adjective and derivational family (相關形容詞及派生詞)

Your sentence is connected to:

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply **powerful**.”

Although the passage contains **powerful**, the underlying noun is **power**.

Meaning connected to this passage

Here, the relevant sense of **power** is:

> **the ability to produce a strong effect or influence**

So:

> **the power of kindness**

means:

> **善良能夠影響、支持、安慰甚至改變別人的力量**

繁體中文：**產生影響、改變結果或令事情發生的能力 / 力量**

For example:

> “Kindness has the **power** to change people.”

「善良有**改變人的力量**。」

1. **power = ability to cause an effect (力量 / 影響力) — 產生作用或改變的能力**

This is the sense most closely connected to your passage.

Practice 1

> “Kindness has the **power** to comfort people.”

「善良有**安慰別人的力量**。」

Practice 2

> “Words have the **power** to change how people think.”

「言語具有改變人們思想的**力量**。」

power = 令某件事情發生、改變或產生顯著效果的能力

2. **the power of + something (.....的力量)** — 影響力；作用力

Practice 3

> “The book explores the **power of kindness**.”

「這本書探討**善良的力量**。」

Practice 4

> “Never underestimate the **power of a simple gesture**.”

「不要低估一個簡單舉動的**力量 / 影響力**。」

the power of something = 某種事物產生影響、改變或效果的能力

3. **power = control / authority (權力)** — 權力；控制權

A major separate meaning.

Practice 5

> “The manager has the **power** to make the final decision.”

「經理有**權力**作最後決定。」

Practice 6

> “No single person should have too much **power**.”

「任何一個人都不應擁有過多**權力**。」

power = 控制事情、作決定或影響別人行動的能力 / 權限

4. **have the power to + verb** (有權 / 有能力做) — 有權力 ; 有能力

Practice 7

> “The court has the **power to** stop the order.”

「法院有**權力**阻止這項命令。」

Practice 8

> “Small actions have the **power to** change a relationship.”

「小小的行動也有**能力**改變一段關係。」

have the power to = 擁有足夠權力、能力或影響去做某事

The Chinese depends on context:

* legal/organizational → 有權

* general effect → 有能力 / 有力量

5. **power** = political authority (政治權力 / 政權) — 政權 ; 執政權

Practice 9

> “The new government came to **power**.”

「新政府**上台執政**。」

Practice 10

> “The party remained in **power** for several years.”

「該政黨**執政**了數年。」

power = 控制政府、制定政策和作政治決策的權力

6. **come to power (上台掌權) — 掌權 ; 執政**

Practice 11

> “The government came to **power** after the election.”

「該政府在選舉後**上台執政**。」

Practice 12

> “The movement eventually came to **power**.”

「該運動最終**取得政權**。」

come to power = 開始掌握政府或政治控制權

7. **be in power (執政) — 掌權 ; 執政**

Practice 13

> “The party was in **power** for eight years.”

「該政黨**執政**了八年。」

Practice 14

> “Who was in **power** at the time?”

「當時是誰**執政**？」

be in power = 正在掌握政府 / 政治控制權

8. **power = physical force / strength (力量) — 力量 ; 威力**

Practice 15

> “The wave hit the rocks with enormous **power**.”

「海浪以巨大的**力量**拍打岩石。」

Practice 16

> “She struck the ball with great **power**.”

「她以很大的**力量**擊球。」

power = 能產生動作、衝擊或物理效果的力量

9. **power** = energy / electricity (電力 / 能源) — 電力；動力

A major modern sense.

Practice 17

> “The building lost **power** during the storm.”

「暴風雨期間，大樓**停電**了。」

Practice 18

> “This machine uses very little **power**.”

「這部機器耗用很少**電力 / 能源**。」

power = 供機器、設備或建築物運作所需的電力或能源

10. **power supply** (電力供應 / 電源) — 電源；供電

Practice 19

> “The storm interrupted the **power supply**.”

「暴風雨中斷了**電力供應**。」

Practice 20

> “Check the computer’s **power supply**.”

「檢查電腦的**電源供應器**。」

power supply = 提供電力的系統，或為設備供電的裝置

11. **power failure / power outage (停電) — 電力故障；停電**

Practice 21

> “The storm caused a **power failure**.”

「暴風雨造成**停電**。」

Practice 22

> “The hospital has backup systems for a **power outage**.”

「醫院備有系統應付**停電**。」

power failure/outage = 電力供應暫時中斷

12. **power = machine output / performance (功率 / 動力) — 功率；動力**

Practice 23

> “The new engine produces more **power**.”

「新引擎產生更大的**功率 / 動力**。」

Practice 24

> “The motor needs more **power**.”

「這個摩打需要更大的**功率 / 動力**。」

power = 機械或電氣系統產生能量、做功或輸出的能力 / 速率

13. **computing power (運算能力) — 運算能力；處理能力**

Practice 25

> “Modern phones have impressive computing **power**.”

「現代手機具有很強的**運算能力**。」

Practice 26

> “The project requires more processing **power**.”

「這個項目需要更多**處理能力**。」

computing power = 電腦或處理器進行計算和處理資料的能力

14. **purchasing power** (購買力) — 購買力

Practice 27

> “Inflation reduces purchasing **power**.”

「通脹會降低**購買力**。」

Practice 28

> “Higher wages increased household purchasing **power**.”

「工資上升提高了家庭的**購買力**。」

purchasing power = 一筆收入或貨幣實際能購買多少商品和服務的能力

15. **power** = influence over people/events (影響力) — 影響力；支配力

Practice 29

> “The media has considerable **power** to shape public opinion.”

「媒體有相當大的**影響力**去塑造公眾意見。」

Practice 30

> “Money can give people social **power**.”

「金錢可以帶來社會上的**影響力 / 支配力**。」

power = 能影響別人的思想、行為或事件發展的能力

This overlaps with authority, but does not require formal permission.

16. **economic power (經濟實力) — 經濟力量 ; 經濟實力**

Practice 31

> “The city became a centre of economic **power**.”

「這座城市成為經濟**實力 / 力量**的中心。」

Practice 32

> “Large companies can exercise considerable economic **power**.”

「大型企業可以擁有相當大的經濟**影響力**。」

economic power = 透過資金、市場地位、資源或經濟活動影響結果的能力

17. **military power (軍事力量) — 軍力 ; 軍事實力**

Practice 33

> “The country increased its military **power**.”

「該國提升了其**軍事力量**。」

Practice 34

> “Military **power** alone cannot solve every problem.”

「單靠**軍事力量**不能解決所有問題。」

military power = 一個國家或組織所擁有的軍事實力和能力

18. **power = ability of an institution/system (權限) — 權限 ; 法定權力**

Practice 35

> “The agency has broad investigative **powers**.”

「該機構擁有廣泛的調查**權限**。」

Practice 36

> “The law gives the court additional **powers**.”

「法律賦予法院額外**權力 / 權限**。」

powers = 法律、規則或制度正式賦予某個機構 / 職位的**權限**

Notice the plural is especially common here.

19. **powers** = abilities / capabilities (能力) — 能力 ; 本領

A somewhat formal/literary plural use.

Practice 37

> “His powers of concentration are excellent.”

「他的專注**能力**非常出色。」

Practice 38

> “Age had weakened some of her physical **powers**.”

「年齡令她部分身體**能力**減弱。」

powers = 某人的各種能力、官能或本領

20. **power of observation / imagination** (觀察力 / 想像力) — 能力

Practice 39

> “She has remarkable powers of observation.”

「她有出色的**觀察力**。」

Practice 40

> “Children often have strong powers of imagination.”

「孩子通常有很強的**想像力**。」

****powers of + faculty = 某項心理、感官或智力能力****

21. ****power = mathematical exponent (數學) — 次方 ; 冪****

A genuine technical meaning.

Practice 41

> “Two to the third ****power**** is eight.”

「二的三****次方****是八。」

Practice 42

> “Raise the number to the second ****power****.”

「把這個數提升到二****次方****。」

****power = 數學中表示一個數被自身連乘多少次的指數概念****

22. ****power of ten (十的冪) — 十的次方****

Practice 43

> “A thousand is a ****power of ten****.”

「一千是十的某個****次方****。」

Practice 44

> “Scientific notation uses ****powers of ten****.”

「科學記數法使用****十的次方****。」

****power of ten = 10 自乘若干次所得的數****

23. ****power = magnifying ability (光學) — 放大倍率 ; 度數****

A technical but useful sense.

Practice 45

> “This microscope has greater magnifying **power**.”

「這部顯微鏡有較強的**放大能力**。」

Practice 46

> “The lens has a higher optical **power**.”

「這塊鏡片有較高的**光學度數 / 屈光力**。」

power = 光學系統放大或折射光線的能力

24. **power** = engine-driven / electrically operated (動力驅動) — 電動 / 動力式

In compounds, **power** often modifies a noun.

Practice 47

> “The car has **power steering**.”

「這輛車有**動力輔助轉向系統**。」

Practice 48

> “Use a **power tool** for the job.”

「這項工作使用**電動工具**。」

power + noun = 由電力、機械動力或其他能源驅動的

25. **power tool** (電動工具) — 動力工具 ; 電動工具

Practice 49

> “Always wear protection when using **power tools**.”

「使用**電動工具**時要佩戴防護裝備。」

Practice 50

> “A drill is a common **power tool**.”

「電鑽是一種常見的**電動工具**。」

power tool = 由電力、壓縮空氣等動力來源驅動，而不是單靠人手操作的工具

26. **power button** (電源按鈕) — 電源鍵

Practice 51

> “Press the **power button** to turn the device on.”

「按下**電源鍵**開機。」

Practice 52

> “The **power button** is on the side.”

「**電源鍵**在側面。」

power button = 用來開啟 / 關閉設備電源的按鈕

27. **power** = supply energy to something (供電) — 為.....提供動力 / 電力

Now **power** functions as a verb.

Practice 53

> “Solar panels **power** the building.”

「太陽能板為大樓**供電**。」

Practice 54

> “The battery **powers** the device.”

「電池為這部裝置**提供電力**。」

power something = 為某部機器、設備或系統提供運作所需的能源

28. **power = drive / propel (驅動) — 推動 ; 驅動**

Practice 55

> “A small motor **powers** the wheels.”

「一個小摩打**驅動**車輪。」

Practice 56

> “Wind **powers** the turbine.”

「風力**驅動**渦輪機。」

power = 提供機械力量，使某物運作或移動

29. **power through (撐著完成) — 強行完成 ; 堅持做完**

A common phrasal extension.

Practice 57

> “She **powered through** the final hour of work.”

「她撐著把最後一小時的工作**完成了**。」

Practice 58

> “He **powered through** the difficult section.”

「他咬緊牙關**完成了**那個困難部分。」

power through = 即使疲累、困難或阻力很大，仍以意志或力氣繼續完成

30. **power up / power down (開機 / 關機) — 啟動 / 關閉電源**

Technical phrasal extensions.

Practice 59

> “The computer is **powering up**.”

「電腦正在**開機**。」

Practice 60

> “Please **power down** the system.”

「請把系統**關機 / 關閉電源**。」

power up/down = 啟動或關閉設備的電源

31. **powerful = having great power/effect (強大的 ; 有影響力的) **

Practice 61

> “She gave a **powerful** speech.”

「她發表了一場非常**有感染力 / 有力量的演說**。」

Practice 62

> “The machine is extremely **powerful**.”

「這部機器性能非常**強大**。」

powerful = 擁有很大力量、權力、能力或影響效果的

32. **powerfully = strongly / with great effect (強烈地 ; 有力地) **

Practice 63

> “The film **powerfully** conveys grief.”

「電影**強而有力地**表達悲傷。」

Practice 64

> “She argued her case **powerfully**.”

「她非常**有力地**陳述自己的立場。」

powerfully = 以產生強烈力量、影響或情感效果的方式

33. **powerless = unable to control/change (無力的) — 無權的；無能為力的**

Practice 65

> “He felt **powerless** to change the situation.”

「他覺得自己**無力改變這個情況**。」

Practice 66

> “The workers were **powerless** to stop the decision.”

「工人們**無力阻止**這個決定。」

****powerless = 沒有足夠能力、權力或控制力去改變結果****

34. **powerlessness = lack of control (無力感) — 無力；無助**

Practice 67

> “The experience left her with a sense of **powerlessness**.”

「這次經歷令她產生一種**無力感**。」

Practice 68

> “Long delays can create feelings of **powerlessness**.”

「長時間拖延可能令人產生**無助感**。」

****powerlessness = 缺乏控制、影響或改變情況能力的狀態 / 感受****

35. **empower = give power/agency (賦權) — 賦予能力；授權**

Practice 69

> “Education can **empower** people.”

「教育可以**提升人們的自主能力 / 賦權予人**。」

Practice 70

> “Managers should **empower** staff to make decisions.”

「經理應該**授權**員工工作決定。」

empower = 給予某人更多權力、資源、信心或實際能力，使其能自行行動

36. **empowered** = having greater agency/control (有自主權的) — 更有能力；更有掌控感

Practice 71

> “She felt **empowered** after learning the new skills.”

「學會新技能後，她感到自己**更有能力和自主權**。」

Practice 72

> “Employees feel **empowered** when they are trusted.”

「員工受到信任時，會感到自己**更有掌控感**。」

empowered = 擁有或感受到較多能力、選擇權、控制力或信心去採取行動的

37. **empowerment** = gaining agency/control (賦權) — 賦權；自主能力提升

Practice 73

> “The programme focuses on community **empowerment**.”

「這項計劃著重社區**賦權 / 提升自主能力**。」

Practice 74

> “Education can support personal **empowerment**.”

「教育可以促進個人的**自主能力提升**。」

empowerment = 個人或群體獲得更多能力、資源、信心或決策權的過程

38. **power of attorney (法律) — 授權書 ; 代理權**

A useful established legal compound.

Practice 75

> “She gave her son **power of attorney**.”

「她授予兒子**法律代理權**。」

Practice 76

> “The document grants **power of attorney** over financial matters.”

「該文件授予處理財務事項的**代理權**。」

power of attorney = 法律上授權另一人代表自己作特定決定或處理事務的權限 / 文件

Important distinction: **power vs strength**

strength

often emphasizes:

- * physical force
- * resilience
- * degree of intensity
- * a strong quality

power

often emphasizes:

- * ability to cause change
- * control
- * authority
- * energy

Compare:

> **physical strength**

> = 體力

> **political power**

> = 政治權力

> **the power of kindness**

> = 善良產生影響的力量

Important distinction: power vs force

force

usually emphasizes:

> physical pressure, coercion, or an active push.

power

emphasizes:

> capacity to produce an effect.

A machine may have great **power** even when it is not currently applying much **force**.

Important distinction: power vs authority

power

= actual ability to control or influence.

authority

= officially recognized right to make decisions or give orders.

Someone can have:

> **power without formal authority**

through wealth, influence, or reputation.

Important distinction: power vs influence

power

can involve direct control.

influence

usually means:

> changing how people think or act without necessarily controlling them.

In your grandmother passage, the relevant idea is closer to **influence**:

> kindness has power because it affects people deeply.

Important distinction: **power vs energy**

energy

= capacity for work; also everyday vitality.

power

in physics/engineering:

> rate at which energy is transferred or work is done.

In everyday speech, however, **power** may simply mean electrical energy supply.

Important distinction: **power vs electricity**

electricity

specifically refers to electrical energy/current.

power

can refer more broadly to the electrical supply available to a building/device.

> “The power is out.”

= 停電了。

not:

> “Power” always equals electricity.

Important distinction: **power — singular vs powers — plural**

power

often means:

- * authority
- * influence
- * energy
- * strength

powers

often means:

- * official legal abilities
- * personal faculties/capabilities

> “The police have certain powers.”

= 警方有某些法定權限。

> “her powers of observation”

= 她的觀察能力。

So the plural can be lexically important.

Important distinction: **have power vs have the power to**

have power

= possess influence/control generally.

> “He has a lot of power.”

have the power to do something

= possess the specific authority or ability required for an action.

> “She has the power to approve the plan.”

Important distinction: ****in power vs powerful****

****in power****

= currently governing / holding political control.

****powerful****

= possessing great influence or strength generally.

Someone can be powerful without being in government.

Important distinction: ****powerful vs empowered****

****powerful****

= already possesses considerable force, authority, influence, or ability.

****empowered****

= has been given or has gained greater ability, autonomy, confidence, or authority to act.

So:

> powerful ≠ empowered

Important distinction: ****powerless vs weak****

****weak****

can mean:

- * physically weak
- * structurally weak
- * low intensity
- * unconvincing

powerless

specifically means:

> lacking the ability or authority to influence what happens.

A physically strong person can still be **powerless** in a particular system.

Important distinction: **empower vs help**

help

= assist someone.

empower

= increase their own ability, authority, confidence, or resources so that they can act themselves.

That distinction matters:

> doing something **for** someone

is not always the same as:

> empowering them to do it **themselves**.

Important distinction: **power — ordinary vs mathematical**

Ordinary:

> “She has a lot of power.”

= 她很有權力 / 影響力。

Mathematics:

> “Three to the second power.”

= 三的二次方。

The mathematical meaning is completely separate in learner use.

Family-extension note

****Power**** is a strong polysemy word because it has several genuinely distinct modern semantic centres:

- * ****ability to cause an effect**** → the power of kindness
- * ****control/authority**** → political or organizational power
- * ****physical force**** → hit with power
- * ****energy/electricity**** → lose power
- * ****machine output**** → engine power
- * ****institutional powers**** → legal powers
- * ****human faculties**** → powers of observation
- * ****technical mathematics**** → power/exponent
- * ****technical optics**** → optical power

Its derivational family then adds:

- * ****powerful****
- * ****powerfully****
- * ****powerless****
- * ****powerlessness****
- * ****empower****
- * ****empowered****
- * ****empowerment****

This is exactly the kind of family where the manual recommends a broad sweep of direct derivatives and common specialist uses, while keeping them accurately labelled instead of pretending they are all separate meanings of the bare noun.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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power — capacity/effect	令某件事情發生、改變或產生顯著效果的能力
the power of something	某事物產生影響、改變或效果的能力
power — control/authority	控制事情、作決定或影響別人行動的權力
have the power to	擁有做某事所需的能力、權力或影響力
power — political	控制政府、制定政策和作政治決策的權力
come to power	開始掌握政治控制權；上台執政
be in power	正在掌握政府 / 政治控制權
power — physical force	能產生動作、衝擊或物理效果的力量

power — electricity	供設備、建築或機器運作所需的電力 / 能源	
power supply	提供電力的系統或裝置	
power failure/outage	電力供應暫時中斷；停電	
power — machine output	機械 / 電氣系統產生能量或輸出的能力 / 功率	
computing power	電腦或處理器進行運算及資料處理的能力	
purchasing power	收入 / 貨幣實際可購買商品和服務的能力	
power — influence	影響別人的思想、行為或事件發展的能力	
economic power	透過資金、市場地位或資源影響結果的能力	
military power	一個國家 / 組織擁有的軍事實力	
powers — official authority	法律或制度正式賦予某機構 / 職位的權限	
powers — faculties	某人的心理、感官或身體能力	
power — mathematics	數學中的次方 / 冪概念	
power — optics	光學系統的放大或折射能力	
power + noun	由電力 / 機械動力驅動的	
power — verb	為機器 / 系統提供能源或驅動力	
powerful	擁有很大力量、權力、能力或影響效果的	
powerfully	以強烈、有力或極具影響的方式	
powerless	沒有足夠能力、權力或控制力去改變事情的	
powerlessness	缺乏控制或改變情況能力的狀態 / 感受	
empower	給予某人更多能力、資源、信心或決策權，使其能自行行動	
empowered	擁有或感受到較多自主能力、控制力或信心的	
empowerment	個人 / 群體獲得更多能力、資源或決策權的過程	
power of attorney	法律上授權另一人代表自己作決定或處理事務的代理權	

For your original passage

The passage uses:

> “Kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply ****powerful****.”

The corresponding noun idea is:

> ****the power of kindness****

Here:

****power = 能深刻影響別人、支持別人，甚至改變別人生活的力量****

So the intended meaning is ****not****:

- * political power
- * physical force
- * electricity
- * machine power

but:

> **the capacity to produce a deep human effect**

That is the semantic core behind **powerful** in your original sentence.